

Dependence of Filipino Young Professionals' Well-being on their Investing Years and Income in the National Capital Region

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ABSTRACT

Understanding the relationship of financial well-being to years of investing and income is essential in achieving personal financial success and laying a solid foundation for financial stability, as well as how young professionals can attain an improved state of financial well-being. In this study, the researchers intended to determine whether years of investing and income correlate with financial well-being of young professionals in the National Capital Region. Using a descriptive-correlational research design, the researchers examined the data collected from 385 young professionals aged 25-35. Findings showed that the years of investing were considerably low but positively correlated to financial well-being. The findings also suggested that while income is a factor in financial well-being, it is not the sole determinant. The findings from the research suggest a need for targeted investment education programs and promotion of financial well-being in initiatives to enhance young professionals' financial well-being.

Keywords: Financial Well-being; Years of Investing; Income; Young Professionals.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Among young professionals, investments in trading like stocks, life and health insurance, and retirement plans are of paramount importance. At the same time, individual short and long-term goals and preferences are considered. According to a Manulife survey (n.d.), managing finances, financial independence, and even starting a business were among the top five priorities identified by 500 Gen Z and Millennials. Young professionals increasingly seek financial independence, which is reflected in purchasing decisions to support goods and services whose future is warranted and corresponds to their beliefs.

Although studies on financial well-being keep progressing, there still is a gap in the research on how income, years of investing, and financial well-being influence each other,

specifically in the case of the young professionals in the National Capital Region (NCR). Despite the amount of existing literature that covers diverse aspects of financial literacy and investment behavior among young professionals, there are no studies that specifically elaborate the role of income levels and year of investment activities in overall financial health in the context of young professionals in NCR. Exploring the nexus between income, investment experience and financial health in this age and locality group is crucial for creation of programs and policies targeted at enhancing the financial health and stability of young professionals that live in cities such as the NCR. Through filling this research gap, scholars and policymakers would better understand the unusual constraints and opportunities that the young people in cities experience while managing their finances and aiming for lasting financial stability.

The study aims to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the level of financial well-being among young professionals in the National Capital Region?
2. What is the relationship between financial well-being and years of investing in young professionals in the National Capital Region?
3. What is the relationship between financial well-being and income of young professionals in the National Capital Region?

Studying the dependence of financial well-being to years of investing and income may enable individuals to make informed financial decisions, promote financial security, improve personal financial management skills and guide policy interventions. The findings can offer insights for understanding similar groups in other emerging economies facing comparable challenges, urbanization, job markets, and accessibility to financial products. The influence of income on well-being observed here might reflect a universal need for financial well-being to meet basic needs and achieve life goals. Similarly, investing years could shed light on the broader benefits of long-term financial planning and the accumulation of financial knowledge that can lead to increased confidence and reduced stress among young professionals in diverse markets (Lusardi & Mitchell, 2014). Therefore, while this study is anchored in the Philippine context, it aims to contribute to a broader understanding of the financial determinants of young professional well-being which offers a perspective through which other nations and sectors can examine their own dynamics.

2. REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

Financial well-being means having enough money to live comfortably (Lambert et al., 2023). It is determined by how an individual control their finances, ability to endure financial stress, meet his or her financial goals, and have financial freedom (Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, n.d.). It also involves control over their financial situation and making choices that align with their values and goals without undue financial constraints (Sabri et al., 2023).

As explained by Erner et al. (2016), the assessment of financial well-being can be objective and subjective. The study indicates that objective financial well-being is quantifiable and emphasizes factors like credit scores, financial capability, and the ability to handle unexpected expenses. On the other hand, subjective financial well-being is often based on personal perceptions and feelings of financial security and control. In comparable financial situations, people's subjective financial well-being may differ (She et al., 2022).

2.1 Financial Well-being of Young Professionals

Modern society has improved financial well-being for young people because they can have a smart and fulfilled life (Manalo et al., 2023). Nevertheless, studies indicate that the setbacks they face on the way to financial independence are altogether different from those which seniors and adults do (She et al., 2022). The same author identified two key categories

influencing young adults' financial well-being: people's feelings and thoughts are affected by both external as well as private conditions. Contextual extraneous factors include external influences such as the economy, market movements, new technologies and social comparisons that are finance related (She et al., 2022). Personal and social attributes are those that include demographic data, personality, values, power of finance and habits, financial growth, lifestyle choices, the early life experience, and even mental health status (She et al., 2022). Unfortunately, millennials often fare poorly financially which can be partly explained by similar decreased rates of net worth and increased ratio of debt to income (Mountain et al., 2021). These factors are considered when looking into the socially driven spending behaviors among the youths (Mahendru et al. 2020; Cherney et al. 2020) as well the impulsive buying habits which are influenced by too much social envy (She et al. 2021; Eren et al. 2012; Aboujaoude 2014). Social media might be the cause of engaging in compulsive shopping behaviors (She et al., 2022; Pahlevan Sharif et al., 2019). Young professionals should focus on creating area-specific solutions to ensure stability in their economic standings and live successful lives throughout their entire lives (She et al., 2021).

Sabri et al. (2023) indicated that a young adult's financial well-being is considered well-rounded if they are able to manage their debts effectively and accumulate sufficient savings for their future financial needs. However, these young professionals are sometimes overwhelmed by the money they receive, which can lead to neglect of long-term financial goals, termed by Konish (2020) as financial burnout. According to a study by Kleimeier et al. (2023), young professionals may face peer pressure to spend on social events and may be advised to prioritize bill payments. Financial burnout can occur when individuals feel pushed to the limit in managing their finances, often due to the more limited cash flow. To combat this, young professionals must have resources and support to manage their finances effectively. Similarly, Azul et al. (2023) found that many young professionals can have good financial well-being if they can manage their finances, live within their means, and overcome financial issues.

Lastly, according to the study conducted by Aripin and Puteh (2018), the financial well-being of young professionals aged 21 to 40 will enhance their quality of life. Concerning the factors of the young professionals' well-being, a study shows that financial behavior, financial literacy, personal traits, social and economic environment, and life stage contribute to their financial well-being, interpreting that this will impact their financial management skills (Lambert et al., 2023).

2.2 Years of Investing to Financial Well-being

The years of investing may impact their investment decisions. This is supported by the study of Lin et al. (2022), the results showed that most of the investors aged 18 to 54 years old, who have less than two years to less than ten years of experience in investing, are likely to engage in various investment vehicles, specifically in bonds, stocks, exchange-traded funds (ETFs), mutual funds, or other securities outside of retirement accounts.

Moreover, Collins and Urban (2019) had this to say that when individuals begin investing at a younger age, they have the advantage of time in the number of years of investing in relation to financial well-being. When they start early in life, their investments have a long period to grow and compound, allowing them to withstand market fluctuations, take advantage of compounding returns, and accumulate wealth over the years. As a result, they may experience positive financial well-being later in life compared to those who start investing later.

2.3 Income to Financial Well-being

There are few studies on the relationship between financial well-being and income level, one study suggested that high income earned with high financial satisfaction improved financial well-being. A study conducted by Sun et al., proved that the income level had a relationship

with financial well-being as a reduction in income was associated with lower financial well-being. Another related study indicated that based on the 2016 National Financial Well-Being Survey, lower-income entrepreneurs suggested that there was a lower level of financial well-being (Guo & Huang, 2023).

On the other hand, there were also studies that indicated a non-significant relationship between the income of an individual and financial well-being. Similarly to the study of Kaur (2023), the research study mentioned that having a lower income and net wealth of young professionals does not necessarily indicate or justify lower financial well-being; it might be better to consider other underlying factors. To support this, another study conducted by Burcher et al. (2018) found that financial well-being does not fully reflect an individual's income but is more the reflection of the financial capability and expectation for success.

3. THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

The relationship among the variables of this study is grounded on three theories, i.e., Subjective Well-being Theory, Life-Course Theory, and Theory of Planned Behavior. The first theory was Conceptualized by Ed Diener, who claimed that subjective well-being refers to a person's overall satisfaction with their life and their emotional well-being, emphasizing the importance of life satisfaction in assessing well-being. Research made by Carton et al (2022) from social housing tenants in Ireland has shown that financial well-being is positively correlated with subjective well-being, indicating that individuals who have better financial well-being also tend to have higher levels of subjective well-being.

Elder (1998), who is known for his work on Life-Course Theory, emphasized the importance of understanding how experience and events throughout a person's life can shape their development and well-being. According to Cheung (2015), income and investing are important factors in life course theory because it can have an impact on an individual's well-being. The theory emphasizes the importance of income in understanding how social, economic and historical factors shape individuals' life over time, therefore showing income as one of the key factors that influence these paths. In terms of investments, life course theory suggests that individuals' investment decisions and strategies may vary depending on their stage of life and financial goals. As highlighted by Collins (2019), life-course theory suggests that financial well-being is influenced by various factors, including early life experiences, accumulation of financial resources, and social mobility. For instance, individuals who start investing at a younger age may have a longer time to accumulate wealth, which can lead to greater financial well-being later in life. In the same manner, individuals with higher incomes may have more resources to invest, which can also lead to greater financial well-being.

Conceptualized by Icek Ajzen, the Theory of Planned Behavior suggests that an individual's behavior is determined by their intention to perform a pattern, which is influenced by their attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control (Lambert et al, 2023). A favorable attitude towards investing may arise from beliefs about the benefits of investing, of which some of them are, wealth accumulation, financial security, or achieving long-term goals (Sinnewe & Nicholson, 2023). When applied to financial decision-making and investing, subjective norms influence individuals' behavior because they are socially expected or approved in the context of financial behaviors (Sun et al, 2018). If individuals are aware and conscious that they have the necessary resources, skills, and investment knowledge to participate in investment activities, they are more likely to have a positive perceived behavioral control and likelihood to invest (Iramani and Lufti, 2021; de Castro et al., 2020). In the context of income, it can affect an individual's subjective norms around financial management as expectations and pressures in society differ based on income level (She et al., 2022).

4. CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

Figure 1 illustrated the correlation of financial well-being to years of investing and income of young professionals in NCR. The overview shows that financial well-being is the dependent variable, while years of investing and income are the independent variables. It explains that the years of investing and income of the young professionals in NCR will impact their financial well-being.

The said framework includes the hypotheses of this study, namely:

H₁: The level of financial well-being has a significant dependence on the years of investing of young professionals in the National Capital Region.

H₂: The level of financial well-being has a significant dependence on the income of young professionals in the National Capital Region.

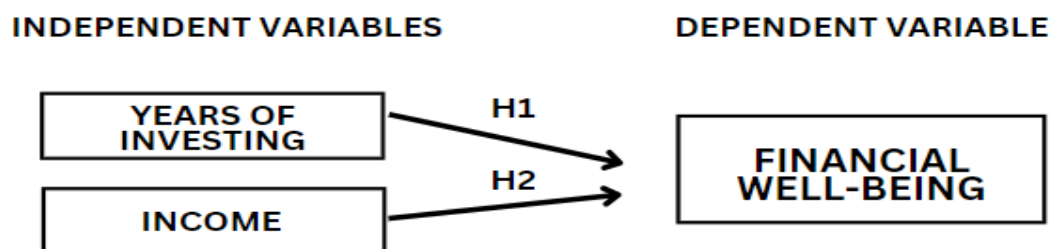


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework

5. METHODS

This study was based on the survey designed to examine the causal relationship between years of investing and income, and financial well-being among young professionals in the National Capital Region. The quantitative approach was used to achieve the research objectives.

The questionnaire, was adopted from the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (n.d.) entitled “Measuring financial well-being: A guide to using the CFPB Financial Well-Being Scale.” The authors of this adopted questionnaire gave permission to the public who will use it, especially for researchers or practitioners. The resulting survey instrument for the current study was validated by academic experts who assessed the nature and complexity of the questions. Afterwards, the survey instrument was pilot tested, yielding a Cronbach Alpha of 0.964, which is considered reliable compared to similar studies. The first part of the instrument was focused on the selection criteria questions which must all be answered in the affirmative, namely, 1.) whether they are 25-35 years old, 2.) if they are working and residing in NCR, and 3.) if they are investing. The second part focused on getting the respondents’ basic information such as age, gender, civil status, highest educational attainment, monthly income, number of years of investing, and where they work in NCR. The third or main section of the questionnaire determined the level of the financial well-being of the young professionals in NCR. This main section consists of 18 questions, answerable with the use of a 4-point Likert scale, denoting “Strongly Agree” to “Strongly Disagree.” The interpretation of the results in the 4-point Likert scale was based on the article of Pimentel (2019), where a 3.51-4.00 interval is the highest,

while 1.00-1.50 is the lowest. On the other hand, questions about years of investing and monthly income are answerable by multiple choice.

The Philippine Statistics Authority (2023, January 23) reported that the National Capital Region comprises of 2,451,596 individuals, both male and female, in the age group of 25 to 35. The sample size was derived using Cochran's formula (Cochran, 1977), arriving at 385 sample size. The researchers implemented an online survey (Google Forms across various social media platforms such as Facebook and Instagram) of 389 young professional respondents in the National Capital Region, employing a purposive sampling technique to select the participants for the study. The survey was conducted from February 9 to March 11, 2024. Table 1 shows the basic information of the 389 respondents.

Table 1. Demographic Profile of the Respondents (n = 389)

Demographics		Frequency	Percentage (%)
Age	25 - 29	253	65.04
	30 - 35	134	34.45
Gender	Female	187	48.07
	Male	289	51.93
Civil Status	Single	280	71.98
	Married	101	25.96
	Separated/Widowed	8	2.06
Highest Educational Attainment	With Master's / Doctoral Degree	42	10.80
	with ongoing MBA	1	0.26
	College Graduate	288	74.04
	College Undergrad/Vocational Graduate	3	0.77
	High School Graduate	55	14.14
Work specifically located in the National Capital Region (NCR)	NCR North	44	11.31
	NCR South	28	7.20
	NCR East	140	35.99
	NCR West	127	32.65
	NCR Central	50	12.85
	Total	389	100.00

Based on the results of Table 1, considering that the total respondents are 389, it suggested that most respondents are 25 to 29 years old, with 253 (65.04%), while the least are 30 to 35 years old (34.45%). In terms of gender, it is evident that there are a majority of male young professionals in the study (51.93%), while there are least female young professionals (48.07%). Moreover, most of the respondents are Single (71.98%), followed by the second highest, which are the Married respondents (25.96%), and the least are Separated/Widowed (2.06%). Furthermore, most respondents are College Graduates (74.04%) as their highest educational attainment. Then, 55 respondents are High School Graduates (14.14%), 42 respondents finished with a Master's / Doctoral Degree (10.80%), followed by 3 respondents are College Undergraduate/Vocational Graduate (0.77%), and 1 respondent with an ongoing MBA (0.26%). Lastly, most of the respondents are working in NCR East with 35.99%, followed by NCR West with 32.65%, then NCR Central with 12.85%, NCR North with 11.31%, and least of the respondents are working from NCR South with 7.20%.

Data was analyzed using Pearson's coefficient correlation to measure the intensity of the relationship between investing and financial well-being (Pearson, 1948). The researchers used the coefficient correlation scale to analyze the results of the relationship between financial well-being and years of investing and income of the respondents (Hinkle et al., 2003). Multiple regression was also used to measure multiple variables present in the conceptual framework (Stanton, 2001).

The researchers diligently safeguarded the confidentiality of sensitive information and anonymity of the shared data in securing participants' identities, defending their privacy rights, and maintaining trust throughout the research process. Also, by ensuring trust and cooperation among participants, the researchers were able to effectively communicate and collect data, thus providing them an accurate interpretation of study findings.

6. RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

This section provides the research findings to assist in answering the research questions of this study. It also provides data analysis and interpretation of the findings.

Table 2. Investing years and Income of the Respondents (n = 389)

Variables	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Number of Years in Less than 1 year	129	33.16
Investing in Asset 1-2 years	154	39.59
Classes 3-4 years	58	14.91
5 years and above	48	12.34
Monthly Income Less than 10,000 PHP	40	10.28
10,001 to 20,000 PHP	74	19.02
20,001 to 50,000 PHP	176	45.24
50,001 PHP and above	99	25.45
Total	389	100.00

Regarding the number of years that the respondents are investing in asset classes, 39.59% of the respondents are investing for 1 to 2 years, 33.16% are investing for less than one year, 14.91% of them are investing for 3 to 4 years, and 12.34% of the respondents are investing for five years and above. With the monthly income of the respondents, 253 of the respondents had a monthly income of 20,001 to 50,000 PHP with 45.24%, followed by 99 respondents with 50,001 PHP and above monthly income (25.45%), then 74 respondents with 10,001 to 20,000 PHP (19.02%), and at 10.28%, 40 respondents with Less than 10,000 PHP monthly income. Table 3 shows the financial well-being of the respondents.

Table 3. Level of Financial Well-being

Item	Indicator/Statement	Mean	Interpretation
FWB1	I could manage a significant unforeseen expense while not pulling out my stock, mutual funds, real estate, and bonds investment.	3.24	Very Good
FWB2	I am capable of solving my financial problems.	3.30	Excellent
FWB3	I can handle setbacks and economic downturns, even considering my stocks, bonds, mutual funds, and real estate investments.	3.26	Excellent
FWB4	I have extra savings allotted for investing in asset classes such as stocks, bonds, mutual funds and real estate.	3.34	Excellent
FWB5	I am not worried about my current financial situation.	3.17	Very Good
FWB6	My financial advisor helps me make informed decisions about my money.	3.06	Very Good
FWB7	I have an emergency fund that can cover at least three months of my expenses.	3.30	Excellent
FWB8	Understanding economic trends influences my decisions in asset classes like stocks and mutual funds.	3.36	Excellent
FWB9	My finances are the driving force in my life.	3.40	Excellent

FWB10	I am just getting by financially and maintaining my investment in asset classes.	3.26	Excellent
FWB11	I am not concerned about my present financial status.	3.11	Very Good
FWB12	I feel secure about my financial future based on my current income.	3.21	Very Good
FWB13	I am saving enough for financial well-being and a comfortable retirement.	3.33	Excellent
FWB14	My income will be sufficient to help me achieve my long-term financial goals.	3.20	Very Good
FWB15	I can handle unexpected expenses.	3.21	Very Good
FWB16	My income can handle expenses, savings, and investments.	3.28	Excellent
FWB17	I spend about 10% of my income on investing in asset classes.	3.22	Very Good
FWB18	I am confident that I can achieve any financial goal.	3.30	Excellent
Overall Financial Well-being		3.25	Excellent

Table 3, regarding financial well-being, demonstrates that most respondents excellently believed that their finances were the driving forces of their lives, with a 3.40 mean. Then, with a 3.36 mean, the respondents consider the economic trends in selecting their asset classes, while the respondents have extra savings for investing asset classes with a 3.34 mean. Also, the respondents are saving for their financial well-being to have a comfortable retirement (3.33 mean). Furthermore, the respondents, with a total mean of 3.30, excellently solve financial problems, have emergency funds, and are confident with their financial goals. Additionally, the respondents can handle their expenses, savings, and investments with their income (3.28 mean). With a total mean of 3.26, the respondents can handle financial setbacks and economic downturns and get by financially to maintain their investments. The respondents also can manage some unforeseen expenses with a total mean of 3.24, while with a 3.22 mean, the respondents are expected to save 10% for investing purposes. Followed by 3.21 mean, the respondents feel a sense of financial security with their current income and can handle unexpected expenses. Moreover, the respondents also believed that their income is sufficient to achieve their financial goals with a 3.20 mean, they are not worried about their current financial situation with a 3.17 mean, and they are also not concerned about their current financial status with a 3.11 mean. Lastly, with a total mean of 3.06, respondents have financial advisors helping them make decisions in investing.

6.1 Pearson Correlation Coefficient

Table 4 presents the correlation among the dependent and independent variables of the study. The control variable used was education (highest educational attainment) which has the highest significance among the demographics in the correlation analysis with p value of .000. Age may also be highly correlated with financial well-being, but all respondents were all within the age class of 25 to 35, and their effect on the dependent variable by subdividing them into 2 sub-classes seems to have less relevance in this study. Another control variable used which is expected to influence investors' financial decisions is financial behavior. Generally, it could be assumed that investors are risk averse (Mandigma, 2021) and this behavior could affect their investment strategies.

Table 4. Correlation Analysis of Financial Well-being to Years of Investing and Income

		Investing Years	Income	Education	Finance Well-being
Investing Years	Pearson Correlation	1	.441**		.364**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.000		.000
Income	Pearson Correlation	.441**	1	.244**	.309**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000		.000	.000
Education	Pearson Correlation	.383**	.244**	1	.288**

	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	.000**		.000
Financial	Pearson Correlation	.263**	.154	.182**	.309**
Behavior	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	.002	.000	.000
Financial	Pearson Correlation	.364**	.309**	.288**	1
Well-being	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	.000	.000	

** Correlation is significant at .01 level (2-tailed)

This table demonstrates a significantly positive relationship between years of investing and the level of financial well-being of the young professionals in NCR, with a 0.364 Pearson correlation. Similarly, there is also a low positive relationship between income and the level of financial well-being of the respondents, with a 0.309 Pearson correlation. These results not only support but also validate the contention that the level of financial well-being is significantly correlated with the young professionals' years of investment and income level.

Interestingly, Table 4 also reveals that the control variable highest educational attainment has a significant low positive correlation to both the independent variables (investing years, and income) and the dependent variable, level of financial well-being. The same can be said of another control variable, financial behavior.

6.2 Regression Analysis

The ensuing tables summarize the results of the regression analysis. To enhance the empirical findings, some more regression specifications using different combinations of independent and control variables were tested as follows:

- Dependent Variable: Financial well-being
- Predictors: (Constant), Years investing in Asset Classes
- Predictors: (Constant), Years investing in Asset Classes, Income
- Predictors: (Constant), Years investing in Asset Classes, Income, Education
- Predictors: (Constant), Years investing in Asset Classes, Income, Financial Behavior

Table 5. Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	.364 ^b	.132	.130	.43756
2	.400 ^c	.160	.155	.43118
3	.411 ^d	.169	.162	.42946
4	.789 ^e	.623	.620	.28921

Model 1 use the independent variable investing years only. Model 2 has 2 explanatory variables, namely, investing years, and income. Model 3 employed 3 predictors as follows: Investing years, income, and the control variable education. It can be gleaned from Table 5 that for Model 1, 13.2% of the variability of financial well-being can be accounted by the variability in years investing in asset classes. Whereas in Model 2, 16% of the variability of financial well-being can be accounted for by the variability in years investing in asset classes and income. Model 3 reveals that 16.9% of the variability of financial well-being can be accounted by the variability in years investing in asset classes, income and education. Model 4 shows that 62.3% of the variability of financial well-being can be accounted by the variability in financial behavior, income and years investing in asset classes.

Table 6. ANOVA

Model	Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
1 Regression	11.306	1	11.306	59.055	.000 ^b
Residual	74.093	387	.191		

	Total	85.400	388			
2	Regression	13.637	2	6.819	36.677	.000 ^c
	Residual	71.762	386	.186		
	Total	85.400	388			
3	Regression	14.391	3	4.797	26.009	.000 ^d
	Residual	71.008	385	.184		
	Total	85.400	388			
4	Regression	53.196	3	17.732	211.991	.000 ^e
	Residual	32.203	385	.084		
	Total	85.400	388			

Table 6 shows that all 4 models exhibit large F-statistics, indicating evidence that there is a difference between the group means. Also, the *p* values are all .000, indicating that there is a statistically significant difference between the means of the groups. Thus, Table 7 shows all the explanatory variables identified in the current study which comprise the ideal multiple regression model by using only statistically significant predictors from a larger collection of potentially predictive variables (Arena et al., 2023).

Table 7. Coefficients

Model	Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	t	Sig.
	B	Std. Error	Beta		
1 (Constant)	2.896	.052		56.225	.000
Years investing	.173	.023	.364	7.685	.000
2 (Constant)	2.707	.074		36.649	.000
Years investing	.134	.025	.283	5.437	.000
Income	.094	.027	.184	3.541	.000
3 (Constant)	2.597	.091		28.415	.000
Years investing	.125	.025	.263	5.004	.000
Income	.065	.030	.127	2.157	.032
Education	.108	.053	.116	2.022	.044
4 (Constant)	.531	.112		4.761	.000
Years investing	.053	.017	.112	3.135	.002
Income	.077	.018	.151	4.315	.000
Financial behavior	.725	.033	.706	21.747	.000

Table 7 depicts the regression analysis for the 4 models of financial well-being as the explained variable of the predictors investing years, income, education, and financial behavior. It can be seen that all combinations of explanatory variables (inclusive of the control variables education or financial behavior) resulted in significant positive effect on financial well-being. Thus, both H_1 and H_2 of this study are supported.

6.3 Discussion

6.3.1 The level of financial well-being of young professionals in NCR

Results show that young professionals in NCR have sufficient levels of financial well-being. Respondents demonstrate moderate financial stability and can manage spending, savings, investments, setbacks, and unplanned costs. This is in line with the findings of Azul et al (2023), where young professionals can achieve good financial well-being by effectively managing their money, living within their budget, and successfully addressing any financial

challenges they can encounter. Moreover, respondents have a slightly confident attitude in their financial objectives, income management, and security. Based on responses, knowing how to prioritize, plan for challenges, and achieve financial stability can lead to future satisfaction. This validates Elder's Life Course Theory, where it is used to understand how adolescence is connected to earlier development and life events in relation to situations that are linked to later health and well-being. In the study of She et al. (2021), professional adults are considered to have a positive financial attitude and the ability to manage finances, enhancing their financial well-being. This suggests that having financial control is more likely to exhibit financial well-being among young professionals.

6.3.2 The level of financial well-being's relationship on years of investing

Findings show that the level of financial well-being to years of investing is significantly low but significantly correlated. This is in agreement with the findings of Hu et al. (2021) on subjective well-being that there is a significant correlation between years of investing and an individual's financial well-being. According to a BSP Annual Report (2023), the effect of the pandemic has reached a realization of saving and investing for circumstances like the recent contagion. This is also consistent with the conclusions of Cheung (2016) emphasizing the importance of income in understanding historical factors that shape the individual's life over time. This is where the Theory of Planned Behavior made by Lambert et al (2023) comes into play. Respondent's subjective norms involve social pressure on engaging in a behavior, which could include the encouragement of friends, family, or influencers regarding investing. Their perceived behavioral control refers to putting the first two factors into action, which in this context would be the investor's confidence in deciding to invest, thereby learning to value their financial well-being and practice appropriate financial planning.

6.3.2 The level of financial well-being's relationship on income

Findings indicate that there is a low but significant correlation between financial well-being and income. This agrees with the findings of Mahdzan et al (2020) and Prakash et al (2022), emphasizing that the relationship of income and financial well-being are directly proportional. The study conducted by Burcher (2017) showed that financial well-being is not fully reflecting an individual's income but is more of the reflection of the financial capability and expectation for success. Moreover, the findings is also in line with Yu and Chen's (2016) discussion on subjective well-being where absolute argument states that income helps individuals meet certain needs, in turn, directly contributing to their satisfaction, happiness and financial well-being. Indeed, income can influence the financial well-being of young professionals. Higher-income levels generally contribute positively to financial well-being by providing individuals with more resources to meet their financial needs, save for the future, and achieve their desired lifestyle (Rahman et al., 2021). However, some studies use the demographic profile, which comprises the income level, in testing for the influence on financial well-being.

7. CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

7.1 Conclusions

The study found significant low correlations of financial well-being to years of investing, income, education, and financial behavior. Given more income, longer investment years, higher education level, and sound financial behavior, a possible increase of one's financial well-being may exist. People with higher incomes, and level of education bring higher financial well-being and can find more investment opportunities in longer years if they are not risk averse. Moreover, investing is also longer for financially and emotionally stable people than those struggling financially. Also, people with a higher income can put money into many

investment platforms. In contrast, those less familiar with investing may have developed strategies that work closely with their financial goals.

The observed relationship between income and well-being reflects a fundamental human need for financial resources to ensure security and pursue life goals. This dynamic is likely to be present in other developing nations experiencing economic growth and urbanization. In countries with similar socio-economic structures to the Philippines, a comparable study might yield analogous results regarding income's impact on young professionals' well-being, though the threshold for significant impact might differ based on cost of living and cultural expectations. Even in developed economies, the relative impact of income increases on well-being could show similarities particularly for young professionals early in their careers facing housing costs or student loan debts, as seen in urban centers in the United States (Simonse et al., 2024)

Further, the influence of investing years on well-being also gives relevance across different markets. In industries with high income volatility, such as the gig economy, the ability to leverage investment for long-term financial stability could be a crucial factor in mitigating stress and enhancing overall well-being (Mbonigaba, 2021). Similarly, in markets where pension systems are less robust, retirement planning falls more heavily on individual investment which makes the experience gained over years of investing which is a predictor of well-being among young professionals concerned with their financial future, (Lusardi & Mitchell, 2014) A highly regulated and accessible market like Singapore might see a stronger impact of investing years compared to a less developed market with limited investment options. Additionally, industry-specific factors such as job security, benefits packages, and compensation structures can influence the relative importance of well-being. (To et al., 2020)

Furthermore, future research could test the generalizability of these findings by conducting comparative studies across different countries, industries and markets. It is important to note the economic development levels, compensation models and regulatory policies in investments. Such studies would provide a more nuanced understanding of how financial factors universally and differentially impact young professional well-being that will allow for more tailored policy recommendations and financial literacy programs globally.

7.2 Recommendations

Young professionals who have already started investing should continue. Consequently, they shall endeavor to develop a broader-based investment horizon, realizing that money invested generates income and investment job opportunities in the future. Consequently, this enhances the chances of them consistently having sustainable financial outcomes since they can make strategic investment choices that are in tandem with their long-term financial objectives. Also, these variables enable advisors to assist their clients in making choices about investments that will conveniently support their financial stability and deliver results that match their goals.

Analyzed results can be critical to leaders and financial professionals, and they should use them to invent precise measures to solve the financial situation of young professionals. The findings of the study could offer business and policy proposals (Mendoza et al., 2023) to further boost the well-being of young investors in the country. They could offer policy makers insights (Mandigma and Badoc-Gonzales, 2022) on how a stronger financial platform that leads to economic welfare can be achieved by instigating programs that aid income growth and sustain financial involvement from investors.

Future researchers may consider integrating triangulation methods, where researchers can conduct both qualitative and quantitative research. Thus, researchers can gain more comprehensive information regarding what influences people to use, which investment forms they use, and how the choices affect their financial literacy and well-being. Future researchers may opt for a larger sample size to enhance the study results' reliability and unpredictability

and organize face-to-face interviews or focus groups with young professionals who are actively investing. The existing correlational gap allows future researchers to conduct extensive research, arrive at new insights, propose targeted interventions, and contribute to improving financial well-being across diverse demographics, including young professionals in the NCR.

7.3 Implications

In the light of the correlation and dependence of financial well-being to years of investment and income, the provision of targeted investment education programs is of no doubt. These plans should seek to do not just that but also to improve the knowledgeability of individuals with regard to how longer investment and income can affect one's financial well-being and also, various investment strategies and the long-term gains that are achieved from investing. Since the academe is a rich ground for professionals who are trained to participate in interdisciplinary teams on functional areas (Mandigma, 2017), they can create an environment and a chance of better financial decisions through raising financial education and by intending the participants to act responsibly.

Financial well-being, investing years, and income draws the importance of enhancing individuals' financial state. The present study recognizes that financial information is important in these relations and functions (Mandigma, et al., 2016). Government and financial institutions will need to have special projects with the intent to develop people and help them in being financially stable. Offering those ways to access affordable financial products, budgeting and saving tools and debt management strategies would be a perfect example. The provision of the mechanisms that deal with financial problems and create a favorable environment makes individuals feel more confident and participate in investing.

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